



National
Qualifications
2024

X854/76/11

**Philosophy
Paper 1**

FRIDAY, 24 MAY

9:00 AM – 11:15 AM

Total marks — 60

SECTION 1 — KNOWLEDGE AND DOUBT — 30 marks

Attempt the question.

SECTION 2 — MORAL PHILOSOPHY — 30 marks

Attempt ONE question.

Write your answers clearly in the answer booklet provided. In the answer booklet you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

Before leaving the examination room you must give your answer booklet to the Invigilator; if you do not, you may lose all the marks for this paper.



* X 8 5 4 7 6 1 1 *

SECTION 1 — KNOWLEDGE AND DOUBT — 30 marks

Attempt the question

1. *The problem with Descartes is that he thinks he can use reason alone as a basis for all knowledge.*

Discuss whether Descartes' reliance on reason as a basis for knowledge is successful.

In your answer you may focus on any part of Descartes' Meditations.

You may wish to discuss one of the following:

- whether the Method of Doubt is effective in establishing reason as a basis for knowledge
- whether the Cogito is an appropriate foundation for knowledge
- whether the clear and distinct rule guarantees certain knowledge through reason alone
- or any other part of the Meditations.

Your essay should do the following:

- describe and explain what Descartes says in this part of the Meditations
- discuss how Descartes uses reason in this part of the Meditations
- evaluate how successful this use of reason is.

30

SECTION 2 — MORAL PHILOSOPHY — 30 marks

Attempt ONE question

2. Read the following situation and answer the question that follows.

A surgeon is about to perform an operation on a ruthless leader of a country who is responsible for the deaths and ongoing suffering of tens of thousands of their own citizens. The operation is risky and during the surgery the surgeon will have an opportunity to cause the death of the leader without appearing responsible.

Would a utilitarian believe that the surgeon is morally required to cause the death of the leader?

In your answer you could include the following:

- explanation of how utilitarianism says we should make moral decisions
- application of utilitarianism to this situation
- discussion of relevant strengths and weaknesses of utilitarianism in relation to this situation
- evaluation of utilitarianism in relation to this situation.

30

OR

3. Read the following comment on utilitarianism and answer the question that follows.

Utilitarianism can't work as a moral theory because it sometimes requires people to act against their intuition.

To what extent is this a fair criticism of utilitarianism?

In your answer you could include the following:

- description of the key features of utilitarianism
- discussion of how the criticism applies to utilitarianism, and how a utilitarian might respond
- discussion of relevant strengths and weaknesses of utilitarianism in relation to this criticism
- evaluation of utilitarianism in relation to this criticism.

30

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National
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2024

X854/76/12

**Philosophy
Paper 2**

FRIDAY, 24 MAY

1:15 PM – 3:00 PM

Total marks — 50

SECTION 1 — ARGUMENTS IN ACTION — 30 marks

Attempt ALL questions.

SECTION 2 — KNOWLEDGE AND DOUBT — 10 marks

Attempt ALL questions.

SECTION 3 — MORAL PHILOSOPHY — 10 marks

Attempt ALL questions.

Write your answers clearly in the answer booklet provided. In the answer booklet you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

Before leaving the examination room you must give your answer booklet to the Invigilator; if you do not, you may lose all the marks for this paper.



SECTION 1 — ARGUMENTS IN ACTION — 30 marks

Attempt ALL questions

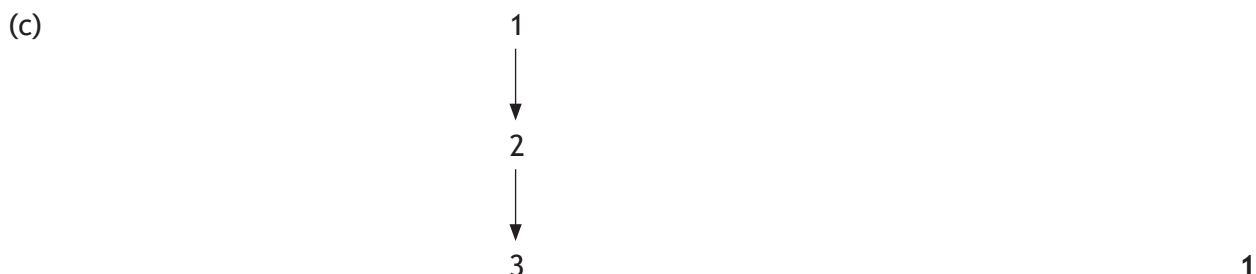
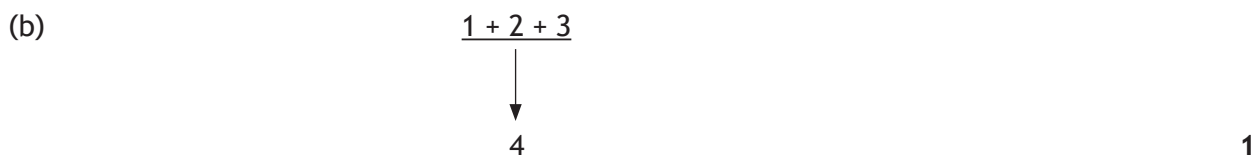
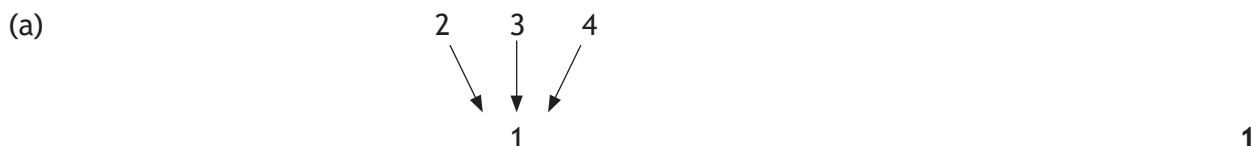
1. Give an example of a word that acts as a conclusion indicator. 1

2. *I don't really like going to the funfair because you must queue for ages for every ride and they are over in about a minute.*

A student claims that the above passage is an argument, as it contains a premise indicator and reasons why they don't enjoy going to the funfair.

Why are they wrong to say this is an argument? 2

3. For each of the following argument diagrams, state whether it shows a linked argument, a convergent argument, or a serial argument.



- (d) Give an example of each of the following types of argument:

(i) linked 1

(ii) convergent 1

(iii) serial. 1

4. (a) What is meant by ‘conductive strength’?

1

- (b) Read the following conductive argument:

P1: The defendant’s fingerprints were all over the gun that was found at the scene.

P2: The bullet that was fired from the gun matches the bullets in the defendant’s drawer.

P3: The defendant was seen on CCTV holding a similar gun the other week.

C: It must be the defendant’s gun that was found at the crime scene.

Discuss whether the premises of this argument are sufficient to establish the truth of the conclusion.

3

5. Read the following argument, which some people may think contains a fallacy:

If a parent lets their child get away with not putting their toys away one day, then the child will think this is okay. Then they will leave their toys around their room all the time. This will lead to them not respecting their parents and thinking it is alright to be rude to them. Before you know it, they will be in trouble at school and with the police. So, you shouldn’t let your child leave their room in a mess.

- (a) Name the fallacy.

1

- (b) Describe this fallacy.

2

- (c) Explain whether you think the argument contains this fallacy, giving reasons for your answer.

2

6. (a) Explain the *ad hominem* circumstantial fallacy.

2

- (b) *My dentist says fizzy drinks are bad for your teeth, but I saw a can of cola on her desk, so they are obviously not that bad.*

What kind of *ad hominem* fallacy is this?

1

[Turn over

7. Read the following argument and answer the questions that follow:

Driving cars can be dangerous. However, we don't make driving illegal because of the dangers: instead, people have to wear seatbelts to ensure that driving is as safe as possible. It should be the same with taking drugs. Drugs can be dangerous, but people are going to take them anyway. Instead of making it illegal, we should make taking drugs as safe as possible.

- | | |
|--|---|
| (a) What is an analogical argument? | 1 |
| (b) How strong is the analogy in this argument? | 3 |
| | |
| 8. (a) Describe lexical ambiguity. | 1 |
| (b) Describe syntactic ambiguity. | 1 |
| | |
| 9. (a) Give an example of an argument that contains the denying the antecedent fallacy. (It is acceptable to simply state the form of the argument.) | 1 |
| (b) Why are the premises of a denying the antecedent fallacy not sufficient to establish the truth of the conclusion? | |
| In your answer you must refer to your example given in question 9a. | 2 |

SECTION 2 — KNOWLEDGE AND DOUBT — 10 marks

Attempt ALL questions

HUME

10. Hume's copy principle is the claim that *'All our ideas or more feeble perceptions are copies of our impressions or more lively ones'*.

Describe the arguments Hume uses to support the copy principle.

4

11. Evaluate Hume's copy principle.

6

[Turn over

SECTION 3 — MORAL PHILOSOPHY — 10 marks

Attempt ALL questions

12. What does Kant mean when he says we ought to always *‘treat humanity, both in your own person and in the person of every other, always at the same time as an end, never simply as a means’*?

You may refer to examples to support your answer.

4

13. What is meant by the term ‘perfect duty’?

1

14. What is meant by the term ‘imperfect duty’?

1

15. Evaluate Kant’s inclusion of imperfect duties in his moral theory.

You may refer to examples to support your answer

4

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